

NEXT Malta 2026 — iGaming operator pipeline

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IN SHORT

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EXECUTIVE RELATIONSHIP

1

*Nicolas Lund, COO,
Nordplay*

IN-PERSON MEETINGS

7

*Nordplay exec +
Louise's Malta
network*

CONNECTIONS TO FOLLOW UP

20

*tier-2 operators to
follow up*

Executive summary

NEXT in Malta is one of Europe's largest iGaming and betting gatherings. A single day on the ground produced a concrete relationship at executive level, a broad operator pipeline — and something more durable: the start of an Aryze agent network in the Malta iGaming ecosystem.

The standout meeting was face to face with Nicolas Lund, COO of Nordplay — a direct, warm relationship at executive level with an active Nordic operator group. Through Louise Beyer Tingager, our introducer on site, we met a group of Malta-based operator and industry leaders, and we prioritised 20 operator connections at tier 2.

The trip also converted relationships into structure. Louise's introducer agreement was moved onto updated terms during the event itself (27 May).

Victor Olinger, Co-CEO of DELULU Gaming, whom we met through Louise, took a follow-up call after the trip and accepted an introducer agreement on 5 June. Anthony and A B, both met on the ground in Malta, are working with us as agents — the first asks went out to them on 31 May.

1 • On the ground

Nicolas Lund — COO, Nordplay. The trip's strongest single meeting: face to face, opening a direct, warm relationship at executive level. Nordplay is a Nordic operator group (Buccone Trading Ltd / NordPlay Malta Ltd, HQ Birkirkara) running five brands on its Swedish licence — Frank & Fred, Klirr, Pop, Jubla and the Onerush sportsbook — with markets in Sweden, Finland and Estonia and roughly 40 employees. Their cashier already runs heavy on account-to-account rails, which makes the conversation concrete rather than educational. Follow-up was sent 31 May with a Money20/20 sit-down proposed.

Through Louise Beyer Tingager, our introducer on site, we also met a group of Malta-based operator and industry leaders — Victor Olinger, Co-CEO of DELULU Gaming (previously Head of Gaming at Vera&John), Christopher Dalli, CEO of L&L Europe, and others below. Emma Formosa gives us a second route into Nordplay.

Justinas Šliažas — 7bet. A planned in-person catch-up: 7bet runs its own group EMI for player processing and was clear that the group rails stay. The one open wedge, agreed before Malta, is Trustly's UK per-transaction cost — if 7bet pays more than GBP 0.50 per transaction in the UK, there is a conversation.

NAME	COMPANY	ROLE
Christopher Dalli	L&L Europe	CEO
Victor Olinger	DELULU Gaming	Co-CEO
Christian Harms	Elevate AI	COO
Emma Formosa	Nordplay	—
Anthony	Independent	Payments consultant

2 • The pipeline — 20 connections to follow up

A prioritised list at tier 2 — senior operator roles (Head of, Director, Country Manager, Commercial, Ops), one level below C-suite.

#	NAME	TITLE	COMPANY	WHY RELEVANT	GEO
1	Diogo Borges	Head of Commercial	Betsson Group	Commercial lead, tier-1 operator	EU
2	Stefano Buse	Chief Commercial Officer	Tipico	Commercial exec, major operator	DE·EU
3	Kresimir Spajic	CEO	Allwyn Digital	Operator CEO (lottery + iGaming)	EU
4	Cristiano Azzolini Di Maggio	Casino Operations Director	Gaming1	Casino operations, BE operator	BE
5	Carl Dyrendahl	Head of Finland	ComeOn Group	Market lead, EU operator	Malta·EU
6	Matti Pöntinen	Country Manager	SkillOnNet	Market lead, UK/ EU operator	UK·EU
7	Dionysios Pavlis	Product Specialist	Kaizen Gaming (Betano)	Product at major EU operator	GR·EU
8	Raul Cue	Product Manager, Casino Integrations	Entain	Product at tier-1 operator	UK·EU
9	Davide Antonelli	Gaming Product Operations	bet365	Product ops, tier-1 UK operator	UK
10	Andrea Mizzi	Sportsbook CRM Manager	Evoke (888)	CRM at tier-1 (888 / William Hill)	UK·EU

11	Giuseppe Festoni	Casino Manager	NetBet	Operations lead, EU operator	Malta·EU
12	Vincent Magro Attard	Head of GRC Systems	FDJ United	Governance / risk, tier-1 operator	FR·EU
13	Karl Dixon	Senior CRM Manager	Suprnation (Betsson)	CRM / retention owner	Malta·EU
14	Gabor Fekete	Key Account Manager	Soft2Bet	Commercial, multi-brand operator	Malta·EU
15	Talat Koseoglu	Head of Casino Ops	iOENT	Operations lead, operator	EU
16	Theuns Jonck	Head of Jackpots	LeoVegas	Product / ops, tier-1 operator	Malta·EU
17	Miroslav Homola	Director, AI & Governance	Superbet	Senior, fast-growing operator	RO·EU
18	Conrad Bugeja	Marketing Director	LiveScore Group	Senior, UK operator	UK
19	Bradley de Wael	Country Lead	Gaming1	Market lead, BE operator	BE
20	Stefano Giancotti	Business Manager	Netwin	Operator, Italy	IT·EU

3 · What became structure — the agent track

The most durable outcome of the trip is not a single deal but the start of an agent network around the Malta iGaming ecosystem:

WHO	BACKGROUND	STATUS
Louise Beyer Tingager	Our introducer on site — the relationships above ran through her. Former operator-side network across Malta.	Formal Aryze introducer; agreement moved onto updated terms on 27 May, during the event.

Victor Olinger	Co-CEO, DELULU Gaming; previously Head of Gaming at Vera&John. Met through Louise at NEXT.	Follow-up call held after the trip; introducer agreement offered and accepted 5 June, paperwork in motion.
Anthony	Independent payments consultant, met on the ground at NEXT.	Working with us as an agent; first asks out 31 May — nightclub and bar contacts for the nightlife track.
A B	Met on the ground at NEXT.	Working with us as an agent; first asks out 31 May — nightclub and bar contacts for the nightlife track.

This matches how the sales strategy is built: agents work the vertical where their industry knowledge is strongest, and conferences are where those relationships get made.

4 • Assessment

An honest assessment of what the trip was worth:

- **Two real assets.** The Nordplay relationship at executive level — and an agent track that turned event relationships into signed and offered introducer agreements within a week.
- **A credible funnel, not yet value.** The 20 are connections, not conversations; their worth depends on follow-up over the coming two weeks, while NEXT is still a warm reference.
- **Full UK/EU reach.** All 20 are in UK and EU operator markets, so we can start outreach right away.
- **Honest risks.** The list is drawn from the event app and not yet verified company-by-company; most relationships are single-threaded; and the Money20/20 sit-down is proposed, not booked.
- **Bottom line.** A strong networking trip with one genuine relationship and a list worth following up — roughly 7–8/10 on outcome, with the score decided by follow-up discipline over the next two weeks.

Where it stands

- **Nordplay:** follow-up sent 31 May; a Money20/20 sit-down proposed and awaiting Nicolas's confirmation.
- **The agent track:** Louise on updated terms; Victor's agreement accepted and in paperwork; Anthony and A B active with first asks out.
- **The 20:** handed into the junior-seller motion — attendee list reviewed, outreach running across UK/EU operators.